Eötvös Loránd University
DOCTORAL SCHOOL OF INFORMATICS

OPERATIONAL REGULATIONS

Translation of the original Hungarian text approved by the University Doctoral Council of Eötvös Loránd University by its decision of 16 October 2025 (Decision No. 6.1).

ELTE

Doctoral School of Informatics Operational Regulations

(In all issues not regulated herein, the Doctoral Regulations of Eötvös Loránd University shall prevail.)

The Doctoral School of Informatics

Section 1

Name of the doctoral school: Doctoral School of Informatics

Headquaters of the doctoral school:
ELTE Faculty of Informatics
1117 Budapest, Pázmány Péter sétány 1/C

Year of establishment of the doctoral school: 2001

The Doctoral School of Informatics (hereinafter referred to as DS) is accredited by the Hungarian Accreditation Committee (MAB) and prepares students for higher university degrees and doctoral (PhD) degrees within the framework of organised and individual training programmes. The aim of the training is to ensure a continuous supply of internationally competitive IT teachers and researchers, as well as to provide highly qualified research and development professionals to meet the labour needs of the domestic ICT sector. These goals are primarily achieved through participation in organised training, during which doctoral students and doctoral candidates prepare for independent teaching and research careers in a community of leading professors and researchers, as well as experts from accredited external scientific institutions. The Doctoral School of Informatics is an institution consisting of core members, lecturers, supervisors, doctoral students and doctoral candidates.

Doctoral programmes

Section 2

(1) The Doctoral School of Informatics offers six doctoral programmes approved by the Doctoral Council of Informatics (IDT):

- Doctoral Programme in Software and Computer Science
- Doctoral Programme in Data Science, Networks, Information Systems
- Doctoral Programme in Scientific Computing and Models, Numerical and Symbolic Methods
- Doctoral Programme in Informatics Teaching Methodology
- Doctoral Programme in Geospatial Information and Spatial Data

- Doctoral Programme in IT Solutions in Engineering Sciences

(2) Scientific and educational activities in the programmes of the Doctoral School are managed and controlled by the Head of the Doctoral Programme, who is a core member of the doctoral school.
(3) The curriculum of the doctoral programmes, which is part of the Doctoral School Educational Plan, contains the research programmes (topics) and educational activities (lectures, seminars, practices) approved by the Doctoral School Council. Only instructors approved by a resolution of the Doctoral Council of Informatics and the Council of the Doctoral School shall become lecturers and supervisors in the doctoral programme.

(4) The professional work of the doctoral student enrolled in the doctoral programme is overseen by his/her supervisor. Supervisors provide support to students in determining and scheduling the compulsory and elective courses required to fulfil their study obligations, in developing the doctoral study plan and semester study plans, provides the doctoral student with the professional and methodological knowledge necessary to complete the doctoral training, and supervises and monitors the student's research work and evaluates its results. By signing, the supervisor accepts the doctoral student's doctoral study plan, the updated semester study and research plan corresponding to the training phase, and evaluates the doctoral students research performance on a semester basis, which is approved by the signature of the head of the doctoral programme. If the supervisor is unable to perform his or her duties, the head of the doctoral programme shall act in his or her place, and his or her signature may be replaced by that of the head of the doctoral programme.

Administration of the Doctoral School of Informatics

Section 3

(1) The task of the Department of Academic and International Relations of the Faculty of Informatics (hereinafter referred to as TNKCs) is to perform the administrative tasks of the Doctoral School of Informatics under the supervision of the Head of the Doctoral School and the Vice-dean for International Affairs and Projects.
(2) The tasks of the TNKCs are:

a) announcing the admission procedure for doctoral students and assisting in its implementation;
b) provides information on the admission procedure upon request and assists in contacting supervisors;
c) performs administrative tasks related to doctoral students' studies from the start of their doctoral training until the completion of the doctoral procedure;
d) records data on students and their studies in the Neptun Education System;
e) performs administrative tasks related to student finances, collects tuition fees payable during doctoral training and the doctoral procedure;
f) collects and forwards requests for reducing or waiving fees to the head of the doctoral school and the chair of the Doctoral Council of Informatics;

g) collects study-related requests from doctoral students and doctoral candidates and forwards them to the head of the doctoral school and the chair of the Doctoral Council of Informatics;
h) receives applications for the conduct of doctoral procedures and performs administrative and formal verification tasks related to the procedures;
i) keeps the minutes of the Doctoral Council of Informatics and the Doctoral School Council, and assists in the organisation of the meetings of the Doctoral Council of Informatics and the Doctoral School Council;
j) performs administrative tasks related to the lecturers' contracts of services;
k) provides office hours for doctoral students at the TNKCs office for personal administration of matters related to their studies;
l) maintains contact with students, informs doctoral students about announced calls for applications and all important information concerning them;
m) manages the doctoral school's website and ensures that information related to doctoral training is kept up to date;
n) ensures that information about the ELTE Doctoral School of Informatics is regularly updated on the official website of the National Doctoral Council;
o) prepares regular and ad hoc reports and data on the activities of the doctoral school under the supervision of the head of the doctoral school;
p) The TNKCs performs the administrative tasks of the Doctoral School of Informatics under the direction of and in cooperation with the head of the Doctoral School.

The Doctoral Council of Informatics

Section 4

(1) The tasks of the Doctoral Council of Informatics are governed by Articles 9-11 of the University Doctoral Regulations and by Articles 1 and 2 of the Faculty Doctoral Regulations of the Faculty of Informatics, which contain faculty specific features.

(2) The Doctoral Council of Informatics shall have a quorum if more than half of its voting members are present at its meeting, including the chair or vice-chair.

(3) The Doctoral Council of Informatics shall make its decisions by simple majority, with the exception of personnel matters and the awarding, recognition or rejection of doctoral degrees. When making a decision by simple majority, members may vote "yes" or "no".

(4) The Doctoral Council of Informatics shall decide on personnel matters, the awarding and recognition of doctoral degrees, and the rejection of the awarding and recognition of doctoral degrees by secret ballot, in which case members may cast a "yes" or "no" vote. Invalid votes shall be disregarded for the purposes of decision-making.

(5) The Doctoral Council of Informatics may also make its resolutions (decisions) by postal vote, if so ordered by the chair. In this case, the chair shall inform the members by e-mail via the electronic voting system of the subject of the resolution and the deadline for casting votes. The deadline for casting votes in an electronic vote shall be no less than 15 minutes and no more than 1 day. The chairperson shall tally the votes cast after the deadline for voting.

Head of the Doctoral School of Informatics

Section 5

The regulations concerning the Head of the Doctoral School are contained in Section 15 of the University Doctoral Regulations and Sections 4 (a) and (b) of the Faculty Doctoral Regulations of the Faculty of Informatics, which contain specific provisions relating to the Faculty of Informatics.

The Doctoral School Council

Section 6

(1) The duties of the Doctoral School Council are regulated by Section 16, paragraphs 1-4 of the University Doctoral Regulations, and Section 5, paragraphs 1-3 of the Faculty Doctoral Regulations containing the specific characteristics of the Faculty of Informatics. (The Doctoral School Council of Informatics may also be referred to by the abbreviation DOIT).

(2) The Doctoral School Council shall have a quorum if more than half of the members with voting rights are present at the meeting, including the chair or vice-chair.

(3) The Doctoral School Council makes its decisions by simple majority vote, and members may vote "yes" or "no" on a simple majority resolution (decision).

(4) The chair of the Doctoral School Council may order a secret ballot if necessary. In this case, members may cast a "yes" or "no" vote. Invalid votes shall be disregarded for the purposes of decision-making.

(5) The Doctoral School Council may also adopt its resolutions (decisions) by postal vote, if so ordered by the chairperson. In this case, the chairperson shall inform the members of the subject of the resolution and the deadline for casting votes by e-mail via the electronic voting system. The deadline for casting votes in an electronic vote shall be no less than 15 minutes and no more than 1 day. The chairperson shall tally the votes cast after the deadline for voting.

The doctoral programme

Section 7

(1) Any member of the Doctoral School Council may propose the establishment of a doctoral programme in accordance with Section 18 (3) of the University Doctoral by submitting a training plan and a proposal presenting the new programme, in agreement with the head of the doctoral school. The proposal for the establishment of a doctoral programme shall include the professional justification for the doctoral programme and the proposal for the head of the doctoral programme. Proposals for the establishment of doctoral programmes shall be submitted to the Doctoral School Council by 31 March each year at the latest. The proposal accepted by the Doctoral School Council shall be submitted by the head of the doctoral school to the Doctoral Council of Informatics by 30 April each year at the latest.

(2) The head of the doctoral programme or the head of the doctoral school may submit proposals for amendments to the doctoral Educational Plan to the Doctoral School Council by 28 February

each year. The head of the doctoral school shall submit the amendment to the doctoral Educational Plan approved by the Doctoral School Council to the Doctoral Council of Informatics by 31 March each year.

(3) At the request of the head of the doctoral school, the heads of doctoral programmes shall, by the deadline specified by the head of the doctoral school

a) submit an annual summary report to the Doctoral School Council

aa) on the progress of students admitted to the doctoral programme,

ab) the dropout rate and its causes,

ac) the number of student complaints and the measures taken.

b) Furthermore, they may make proposals or, if necessary, shall make proposals

ba) on the research topics to be announced in the call for applications, the supervisors responsible and the number of students to be admitted per topic,

bb) the number of students to be admitted to the doctoral programme,

bc) modifications to the training plan, in particular the range of compulsory and optional courses,

bd) the date of the comprehensive examination and the members of the examination committees,

be) the range of journals and accredited conferences acceptable for publication,

bf) the persons proposed as supervisors,

bg) changes to doctoral students' topics or supervisors,

bh) amendments to the Faculty of Informatics' Doctoral Regulations, operating regulations, and quality assurance regulations and plan, which contain faculty-specific provisions.

c) Furthermore, they shall make proposals for the initiation of the doctoral thesis evaluation procedure and for the official evaluators, together with the supervisor, in accordance with the provisions of Section 65 of the University Doctoral Regulations and Section 19 of the Faculty Doctoral Regulations of the Faculty of Informatics , which contain the specific characteristics of the faculty.

Doctoral training

Section 7

(1) The rules of doctoral training, including changing the topic and supervisor, fulfilling the requirements of the doctoral school and its administration, the method and schedule of individual course registration, course recognition, the minimum credit values to be obtained by doctoral students during specified study periods, the maximum ratio of credit values for courses recognised in the credit transfer procedure, the completion of examinations, and the submission of requests related to the credit system are regulated by Sections 23-56 of the University

Doctoral Regulations and the Faculty Doctoral Regulations of the Faculty of Informatics , which contain the specific characteristics of the faculty.

(2) The rules for applying to and being admitted to the Doctoral School of Informatics are governed by Sections 5-28 of the University Doctoral Regulations and Section 8 of the Faculty Doctoral Regulations containing the specific characteristics of the Faculty of Informatics. The ranking specified in Sections 8 (3)-(4) of the Faculty Doctoral Regulations containing the specific characteristics of the Faculty of Informatics is determined by means of a points system.

(3) The admission committee evaluates the performance of applicants on a scale of 0-100 points and establishes a ranking based on the points achieved. A minimum of 60 points is required for admission. However, 60 points is only a necessary condition for admission, but does not guarantee it, nor does it guarantee the award of any scholarship.

(4) The maximum score of 100 points is calculated based on the evaluation criteria, the submitted materials and the admission interview, as follows:

a) general professional intelligence: maximum 15 points;

b) preparedness and proficiency in the chosen field of study (the specialisation of the doctoral school's training programme): maximum 25 points;

c) degree classification and performance during university studies: maximum 10 points. A degree with a distinction or excellent classification, or excellent academic performance, is worth 10 points; a degree with a good classification or good academic performance is worth 5 points

d) Student Research Conference thesis, other scientific activities: maximum 15 points. National Student Research Conference (OTDK) 1st/2nd/3rd place 10/9/8 points, National Student Research Conference (OTDK) special prize 7 points, faculty TDK (faculty Student Research Conference) 1st/2nd prize 4/3 points. Papers published in scientific journals 7-10 points, papers presented at scientific conferences and published in conference proceedings 6-9 points, book chapters containing independent scientific results 6-9 points. If the total score exceeds 15 points, only 15 points will be taken into account;

e) feasibility of the research plan: maximum 30 points;

f) language proficiency – Admission requirement: at least a B2 complex state-recognised language exam in one language. Language proficiency exceeding the admission requirement: 5 points.

(5) The head of the doctoral school shall ensure that the scoring method is published on the doctoral school's website.

(6) The provisions of Section 63 of Volume II of the ELTE Organisational and Operational Regulations, Student Requirements, and Section 44 of the University Doctoral Regulations shall apply to the conditions for participation in classes and the consequences of non-attendance, from which deviations are only possible at the individual request of the doctoral student and based on the decision of the head of the doctoral school. The request may be submitted by the student at the beginning of each semester during the registration period via the Neptun Education System. The head of the doctoral school shall make a decision within a time

limit that does not jeopardise the doctoral student's ability to fulfil their obligations related to participation in classes.

(7) The provisions of Sections 71-73 of the Academic Regulations for Students (Eötvös Loránd University Organisational and Operational Regulations – Volume 2), shall apply to exam registration, withdrawal of registration, and attempts to retake failed exams within an exam period.

(8) Courses advertised outside the doctoral school shall be recognised in accordance with Section 9 (14) of the Faculty Doctoral Regulations. Students may submit their applications for the recognition of courses advertised outside the doctoral school to the TNKCS office. The application must demonstrate how the course to be taken is related to the student's doctoral training and research tasks. The application must be accompanied by the supervisor's statement and the number of credits recommended by him or her. The Doctoral School Council shall make its decision within a time limit that does not jeopardise the doctoral student's ability to fulfil their obligations related to participation in classes. The TNKCS shall immediately notify the student of the Doctoral School Council's decision via the Neptun Education System.

(9) The head of the doctoral school or the head of the department (institute, research centre) providing doctoral training, the doctoral student and the supervisor may conclude an agreement on the rights and obligations related to the fulfilment of the doctoral student's study plan and the award of the degree. The conclusion of the agreement is mandatory:

a) if a Hungarian state scholarship student wishes to establish an employment relationship with another employer in accordance with Section 40 of the University Doctoral Regulations;

b) with students entering through a comprehensive examination who do not have an employment relationship with the faculty to which their research institution belongs. In this case, the contracting parties shall be supplemented by the head of the research institution who, according to the topic of the doctoral dissertation, is entitled and obliged to organise the research institution debate. If a supervisor is appointed, the agreement shall also include the supervisor's duties and the research institution's obligations regarding the organisation of the research institution debate, the initiation of the degree award procedure and the organisation of the public debate.

The agreement shall be concluded in accordance with Sections 40-47 of the University Doctoral Regulations.

(10) In addition to the written report, research activity without concrete results shall be verified by a consultation log containing the dates and topics of the consultations and a description of the research activities carried out between consultations.

(11) Doctoral students are expected to spend 36-40 hours per week during the semester on activities that can be awarded with credits in the doctoral school.

(12) Doctoral students may only use or disclose to third parties any protected knowledge (know-how) acquired during their doctoral studies after entering into a written agreement with the University and within the framework of that agreement.

(13) Students admitted under Section 40 (6a) of the Nftv (Act CCIV of 2011 on Higher Education) shall submit a detailed research plan at the end of the first semester, setting out a

detailed work plan for the parallel completion of the two programmes, and shall report in writing on their progress at the end of each semester, attaching proof of the credits completed within the framework of the master's programme.

Lecturers and supervisors of the Doctoral School

Section 8

(1) Lecturers may be admitted to the Doctoral School if they meet the following requirements:

a) PhD degree, at least 2 years of scientific professional experience since obtaining the degree, continuous scientific publication activity. Supervisors shall attach a topic proposal to their application, which shall be a modern, novel, feasible scientific topic of sufficient depth for the acquisition of a doctoral degree.

b) Publication and academic requirements for supervisors and lecturers working in the doctoral school: They must engage in continuous publication activity; they must have at least 5 publications dating back 5 years, which may be journal papers, book chapters, conference proceedings, or books or textbooks published by a registered publisher.

(2) The supervisor shall continuously monitor the doctoral student's research work and provide professional assistance for its implementation. To this end, the supervisor shall maintain regular contact with the doctoral student, which shall be documented in writing. The supervisor shall evaluate the student's progress by commenting on the student's reports and determining the credit value of the various tasks of the research work.

(3) The tasks of external and internal supervisors, as specified in Section 8 (9) of the University Doctoral Regulations - Faculty Doctoral Regulations containing the specific characteristics of the Faculty of Informatics, are as follows:

- External supervisor: supervises the doctoral student's research work and provides professional assistance to the doctoral student in the preparation of publications related to their research (journal papers, conference presentations, posters, etc.).
- Internal supervisor: monitors the doctoral student's progress and, if necessary, provides methodological assistance to the student in the preparation and publication of research-related communications (journal papers, conference presentations, posters, etc.) related to their research, issues the necessary certificates for doctoral students in consultation with the external supervisor, and reports on the student's progress to the head of the doctoral programme.

(4) At least once per semester, the internal and external supervisors, together with the doctoral student, evaluate the progress of the research work and the doctoral dissertation, the fulfilment of the requirements for obtaining the degree, and discuss the doctoral student's goals for the next semester. The meeting may be held in person or via an online platform.

(5) Supervisors shall report to the head of the doctoral programme on the progress of doctoral students.

The comprehensive examination

Section 9

(1) The TNKCs shall organise the comprehensive examination.

(2) The Doctoral School Council decides on the dates of the comprehensive examinations, the professional theoretical subjects relevant to the research topic for each examinee, and the composition of the examination committees, based on the recommendations of the Doctoral School Council.

(3) The comprehensive examination of doctoral students participating in organised doctoral training may be held during the spring or autumn examination period.

(4) To apply for the comprehensive examination, at least one publication submitted for publication must be required, which falls into the category of a full scientific paper. The submitted manuscript must be available. It is recommended that the publication be at least accepted for publication. Of the subjects of the comprehensive examination, one subject that prepares students for the comprehensive examination is mandatory.

(5) Section 50 of the University Doctoral Regulations applies to students entering through the comprehensive examination.

(6) In the case of these students, a habitus investigation shall be conducted prior to the comprehensive examination, during which the applicant's professional CV, academic performance prior to submitting the application, scientific publications, other professional work, teaching work, and other activities related to teaching and research not listed above shall be evaluated.

- The habitus investigation is successful if the applicant's documented performance is worth 120 credits. The 120 credits must be distributed as follows: at least 66 credits worth of research/publication performance, which must include at least two high-quality publications, and a maximum of 54 credits worth of documented high-quality professional activity. The applicant's at least five years of activity must demonstrate that they have performed intensive, successful work documented by the high-level use of knowledge beyond university studies. Documented lecturing and teaching work performed at a higher education institution in the relevant field is also considered high-quality professional activity. Credits for teaching may be counted in the manner and quantity specified in the organised training programme. Recommended number of credits for research activities: Professional presentation: 2-4 credits; Presentation at a domestic conference with a published paper: 4-5 credits; Poster at a domestic conference: 3-4 credits; Presentation at an international conference with a published paper: 6-10 credits; Poster at an international conference: 4-8 credits; Professional paper published in Hungarian: 4-8 credits; Professional paper published in a foreign language: 8-14 credits.
- Doctoral students who enter the programme after passing a complex examination without prior doctoral training must complete an additional 120 credits in the next stage of the programme, the research and dissertation phase, they must earn an additional 120 credits to obtain their degree, of which a maximum of 60 credits may be research/publication credits calculated on the basis of specific, documented research

results from the five-year period preceding the comprehensive examination, upon request.

(7) The habitus investigation shall be conducted by the head of the doctoral programme representing the field of study specified in the applicant's research plan, who shall prepare a written evaluation suitable for the Doctoral School Council to formulate its admission recommendation.

Knowledge of foreign languages

Section 10

(1) In order to obtain a doctoral degree, applicants must present at least an intermediate (B2) level complex state language exam certificate or an equivalent certificate for the English language.

(2) The applicants' proficiency in the languages required for the given academic field and the programme, as well as the document certifying their proficiency of the languages, shall be examined and verified by the admission boards. Admission is conditional on the presentation of at least an intermediate (B2) level complex state language exam certificate or an equivalent document.

The doctoral procedure

Section 11

(1) The rules of the doctoral procedure are set out in Sections 58-76 of the University Doctoral Regulations and Sections 11-19 of the Faculty Doctoral Regulations of the Faculty of Informatics, which contain the specific characteristics of the faculty.

(2) Prior to the submission of the doctoral thesis, the department dealing with the scientific field of the topic shall organise a research centre disputation for the preliminary scientific evaluation of the thesis.

(3) In addition to the rules set out in Section 61 of the University Doctoral Regulations, the rules of the Research Center Disputation are as follows:

- The Research Center Disputation shall be organised by the research centre/department, which shall send out the necessary invitations.
- The Research Center Disputation shall be announced on the Doctoral School's website to ensure the necessary publicity.
- The Research Center Disputation’s committee shall consist of a chair and two opponents. The members of the committee must hold an academic degree.
- The chair of the Research Center Disputation is the head of the department/research site. If the head of the department/Research Center Disputation is the candidate's supervisor, someone else must be asked to perform the duties of chair (e.g. head of the doctoral programme).

- In addition to the chair, two opponents must be appointed to prepare a written review of the thesis prior to the defence. One of the opponents must be an external reviewer (not employed by the university). The opponents have a maximum of 60 days to prepare their reviews.
- Opponents invited to the research centre discussion are not excluded from participating as written reviewers in the doctoral degree defence committee, provided they meet the requirements of the University Doctoral Regulations.
- In the case of negative reviews prepared during the Research Center Disputation, it is not necessary to appoint a new reviewer; based on the comments made in the review, the candidate may improve their thesis before submitting it to the Doctoral School.
- An attendance sheet must be kept for the Research Center Disputation, and minutes must be taken of the discussion.
- The minutes of the discussion must include a list of the members of the committee, a brief summary of the reviews, the questions asked during the defence and the answers given, as well as a brief evaluation of the discussion.
- The Research Center Disputation may be conducted in a hybrid or online format if the physical presence of the doctoral candidate or a member of the review committee at the discussion cannot be guaranteed, or if the teaching takes place in a hybrid or online format at the scheduled time of the Research Center Disputation.

(4) The requirements for the submission of doctoral dissertations and theses are set out in Sections 15-16 and Appendix 1 of the Faculty Doctoral Regulations of the Faculty of Informatics, which contain faculty-specific provisions.

Doctoral defence

Section 13

(1) The rules of Sections 67-70 of the University Doctoral Regulations and Section 19 of the Faculty Doctoral Regulations of the Faculty of Informatics, which contain the specific characteristics of the faculty, apply to the public defence and the defence of the doctoral dissertation.

Management of the Doctoral School

Section 14(1) The management of the Doctoral School shall be carried out within the framework of the management of the Faculty of Informatics, and the relevant procedure is set out in the Faculty of Informatics' management regulations.

Quality assurance

Section 15

(1) The Doctoral School of Informatics shall review its operations annually and prepare a report on its financial, educational, research and other scientific activities to date for the Doctoral

Council of Informatics. Based on this report, the Doctoral Council of Informatics shall prepare an evaluation of the activities of the Doctoral School for the University Doctoral Council.

(2) Upon enrolment, doctoral students shall submit an updated study and research plan approved by their supervisor, which shall contain information on the acquisition of the current portion of the 240 credits to be completed during the programme and the schedule for the completion of the research work. The plan to be submitted upon enrolment for the fourth semester shall also include a plan for preparing for the comprehensive examination.

(3) At the end of each semester, the Doctoral School of Informatics reviews the activities and results of doctoral students enrolled in the organised doctoral programme, as well as the results of students entering through the comprehensive examination, for the purpose of evaluating and assisting the students' work. This takes the form of a short written report prepared by the doctoral students, in which they describe the fulfilment of their current study obligations within the framework of the doctoral school and their academic results to date, and which is evaluated by their supervisor in the form of a grade or text. The report is approved by the head of the doctoral programme.

(4) In order to monitor the research activities completed during the semesters, the Doctoral School shall continuously collect and record the publications and other public disclosures of the research results of doctoral students from the date of entry into force of the faculty doctoral regulations. Doctoral students are required to record their published works in the MTMT.